



CATHOLIC SECONDARY SCHOOLS
ASSOCIATION OF NSW

English Advanced

Paper 1 – Texts and Human Experiences

Stimulus Booklet for Section I *and* List of prescribed texts for Section II

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5000-3

Section I

Text 1 –Memoir Extract

From Joy of High Places by Patti Miller

It wasn't until Barney fell out of the sky and was told he wouldn't walk again that flying and walking started to float together in my mind. We had both been tracing tracks across the world – he in the sky, me on earth. I kept notes about my own walking, brief jottings in small notebooks, but I didn't know anything about my brother's journeys.

I asked Barney would he mind if I asked him a few questions about flying. This was a while after his accident, and after all that he'd been through I thought he might not want things stirred up. It felt strange at first.

'So why did you want to fly? When did you get the idea? What was it like the first time?' We were back at the Fountain café, mid-summer, I think. I had seen him a couple of times in Byron Bay when I was working, but it seemed risky to ask such questions so close to where it had all happened.

'The moment my feet left the ground and I was lifted into the air on my first glide, it was exactly how it felt in my flying dreams when I was a kid,' my brother said.

'What were your dreams like?' I'd had flying dreams as a child too.

.....

We didn't share a childhood after all. We were each in a series of our own moments that we stitched together to create our own story. Deep in the neural pathways, neurones fire in intricate patterns, then the hippocampus joins endless nanoseconds together, creating reality. If we sew neatly, edit judiciously, no-one will see the gaps, the shimmer of the void beneath. It will appear to be one whole story, to make sense.

It makes me inclined to simply trace the pieces, the walks and flights, one by one, onto a shared map to see what happens. They happened in different times, are not chronological, but they might form a shape that I'm not yet aware of. Perhaps they will remain distinct. Stories are unpredictable, like walking and flying. As you walk or fly you depend on the weather, on air currents, on the body, on other people. You cannot control all the elements, and if you could, perhaps they each would be robbed of their essence, of their random ability to dissolve what has been certain.

I've decided to start unfolding the map and look at our journeys. The map is made of paper in my mind – I like the paper ones better than slithery phone maps – I enjoy the careful unfolding and then the refolding that is never quite right, and I like that they bear all the scars of my travels, the rips and stains and unreadable smudges. Smooth it out on the table. It's unmarked for now, but it already has the shadows of memory on it, and the blanks of unrecorded and forgotten observation.

Before I walk, I always pore over an actual map – it's always the first thing I acquire, months earlier than I need it. A map lets you see what is possible. You can mark where you have been before and then the placenames on it inspire the next direction. It's like a story spread out into all its possible parts, before the elements have been selected and arranged in order, before a path appears. Walking begins with images in the mind, a place on a map.

Walking comes first. By nature we can walk, flying comes from human invention, which makes it seems logical to start with walking rather than flying.

Text 2 – Prologue to Prose Fiction text

We Are All Completely Beside Ourselves by Karen Joy Fowler

Those who know me will be surprised to learn that I was a great talker as a child. We have a home movie taken when I was two years old, the old-fashioned kind with no sound track, and by now the colors have bled out - a white sky, my red sneakers a ghostly pink - but you can still see how much I used to talk.

I'm doing a bit of landscaping, picking up one stone at a time from our gravel driveway, carrying it to a large tin washtub, dropping it in, and going back for the next. I'm working hard, but showily. I widen my eyes like a silent film star. I hold up a clear piece of quartz to be admired, put it in my mouth, stuff it into one cheek.

My mother appears and removes it. She steps back then, out of the frame, but I'm speaking emphatically now—you can see this in my gestures - and she returns, drops the stone into the tub. The whole thing lasts about five minutes and I never stop talking.

A few years later, Mom read us that old fairy tale in which one sister (the older) speaks in toads and snakes and the other (the younger) in flowers and jewels, and this is the image it conjured for me, this scene from this movie, where my mother puts her hand into my mouth and pulls out a diamond.

I was towheaded back then, prettier as a child than I've turned out, and dolled up for the camera. My flyaway bangs are pasted down with water and held on one side by a rhinestone barrette* shaped like a bow. Whenever I turn my head, the barrette blinks in the sunlight. My little hand sweeps over my tub of rocks. All this, I could be saying, all this will be yours someday.

Or something else entirely. The point of the movie isn't the words themselves. What my parents valued was their extravagant abundance, their inexhaustible flow.

Still, there were occasions on which I had to be stopped. When you think of two things to say, pick your favorite and only say that, my mother suggested once, as a tip to polite social behavior, and the rule was later modified to one in three. My father would come to my bedroom door each night to wish me happy dreams and I would speak without taking a breath, trying desperately to keep him in my room with only my voice. I would see his hand on the doorknob, the door beginning to swing shut. I have something to say! I'd tell him, and the door would stop midway.

Start in the middle then, he'd answer, a shadow with the hall light behind him, and tired in the evenings the way grown-ups are. The light would reflect in my bedroom window like a star you could wish on.

Skip the beginning. Start in the middle.

Glossary:

*Rhinestone barrette-artificial gem hairclip

Text 3 – Nonfiction extract

Introduction by Daisy Hildyard to Matthieu Gafsou's photo essay, H+

The year before I started school I had asthma attacks so often, usually in the middle of the night, that a local charity bought a nebuliser* for me. The nebuliser lived for a year in its small beige plastic case in a corner of my parents' bedroom. I remember the distinct sensation of wearing it when I had an attack, propped up in bed with sofa cushions, the latex mask* moist over my skin, thick menthol-scented white fumes puffing up into my nose and mouth, and the easing feeling as my windpipe opened. My parents, I felt, were overly preoccupied with the concept of sharing, and the nebuliser had a special glamour for me because it was mine. My brother, and the other children who lived nearby, were not allowed to use it, any more than they were able to breathe through my lungs.

There is a woman wearing a respirator much like mine in one of Matthieu Gafsou's *H+* photographs, and it is a strange portrait. The proportions are traditional enough – only head and shoulders are visible – but the subject's face is largely concealed behind the mask which allows her to breathe. The woman is heavily made-up, looking through watery eyes at something beyond the camera; her lips are pursed, her hair hidden under a fluffy cream-coloured diamanté rosette beret*. Ringed fingers, each nail painted a different colour, rest lightly on the tubes. The portrait is unusual because it sees the prosthesis as a part of its subject. The mask is not the incidental or even shameful apparatus of disability, but something this woman shapes and is shaped by: an integral feature of her being. Which, of course, it is.

H+ refers to transhumanism: a movement based on the idea that the human body can be improved on through scientific advancement.

The basic things – orthodontic braces, flathead screws or cups of coffee – testify to the fact that these augmentations* go beyond memory: we have never known a human body without technology. Technology is both oxygen mask and gas chamber. It provides clean drinking water even as it pollutes the reservoir. Our current habits of thought are uneasy with contradiction, which is why the techno-human and the Luddite* competitively mythologise themselves. The rest of us live with the contradiction, or, more accurately, we live inside it.

Glossary:

*Nebuliser- a nebuliser is a piece of medical equipment that a person with asthma or another respiratory condition can use to administer medication directly and quickly to the lungs

*Latex mask-rubber mask

*Diamanté rosette beret- a rose coloured hat with fake diamonds

*Augmentations – extensions

*Luddite- a person opposed to new technology or ways of working

Text 4 – Poem

Stepmother Country

By Kimberley Zeneth

I come to a sunless, nameless beach
Its few shifting sands inlet to the percolating brine

below the cliff rugged waters tug at me
pull at the sleeve of who I might have been
if I had stayed

above the cliff, a mug on stone
plastic bags knotted to a rope
a hole in the rock, a sodden mat

a shallow cave offers respite
from the ravages of wind
and the attention of tourists

here on the edge someone has built
a humble place for sleep, for food
for looking outwards, searching inwards

a slow meanderer who returns
on days her feelings match this place
to step past weathered rags tied to sticks
the random shells and stones of years
collected, thrown down, piled in meditation
on a still afternoon far gone

a trail of broken bottle glass scattered
outwards in a wide arc
green and brown glinting in weak sunlight
a path that might have been a way out

the gulls' cries echo out over
the breaking of a billion tiny things
she wails too, her mouth long ago
forgotten by the shapes of words

I imagine her staring out from the salt-scrub
– wind and silence her familiars

at the tripod meeting of earth, sea, sky
she makes the fourth; fire, boils water for tea
a yeti exiled, weathered hands lift the can

it's going to be wild later tonight
this is stepmother country

the enamel cup burns her thumbs
she sits solidly and she blinks
sipping brine-tainted water
on the brink of a drowning land

Section II

The prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Anthony Doerr, *All the Light We Cannot See*
 - Amanda Lohrey, *Vertigo*
 - George Orwell, *Nineteen Eighty-Four*
 - Favel Parrett, *Past the Shallows*
- **Poetry**
 - Rosemary Dobson, *Rosemary Dobson Collected*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Young Girl at a Window*
 - * *Over the Hill*
 - * *Summer's End*
 - * *The Conversation*
 - * *Cock Crow*
 - * *Amy Caroline*
 - * *Canberra Morning*
 - Kenneth Slessor, *Selected Poems*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Wild Grapes*
 - * *Gulliver*
 - * *Out of Time*
 - * *Vesper-Song of the Reverend Samuel Marsden*
 - * *William Street*
 - * *Beach Burial*
- **Drama**
 - Jane Harrison, *Rainbow's End*, from Vivienne Cleven et al., *Contemporary Indigenous Plays*
 - Arthur Miller, *The Crucible*
- **Shakespearean Drama**
 - William Shakespeare, *The Merchant of Venice*
- **Nonfiction**
 - Tim Winton, *The Boy Behind the Curtain*
 - * *Havoc: A Life in Accidents*
 - * *Betsy*
 - * *Twice on Sundays*
 - * *The Wait and the Flow*
 - * *In the Shadow of the Hospital*
 - * *The Demon Shark*
 - * *Barefoot in the Temple of Art*
 - Malala Yousafzai and Christina Lamb, *I am Malala*

- **Film**
 - Stephen Daldry, *Billy Elliot*
- **Media**
 - Ivan O'Mahoney,
 - * *Go Back to Where You Came From*
 - *Series 1: Episodes 1, 2 and 3*
 - AND
 - * *The Response*
 - Lucy Walker, *Waste Land*

End of Paper

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Text 1-Memoir Extract	Patti Miller. (2019). <i>The Joy of High Places</i> . NewSouth Publishing, Sydney, (pp.15-19) Reproduced with permission of the author.
Text 2- Prologue to Prose Fiction text	Karen Joy Fowler. (2013). <i>We Are All Completely Beside Ourselves</i> . Serpent's Tail, London. (Prologue). Reproduced with permission Profile Books, London.
Text 3- Nonfiction extract	Hildyard, D. (2019, August 1). H+. <i>Granta</i> . Retrieved from https://granta.com/h-plus/ Reproduced with permission of the author.
Text 4- Poem	Kimberley Zeneth. (2014). Stepmother Country. <i>Australian Poetry Members Anthology</i> (Vol. 3). (p.78) Retrieved from https://www.australianpoetry.org/wp-content/uploads/2015/03/APJ-2014-Members-Multimedia-FINAL.pdf <i>The CSSA has made all reasonable efforts to ensure that the copyright owner has consented to this material being reproduced in this examination paper.</i>

COPYRIGHT-FOR PAPER 2

Section II Questions 2-8	Rick Gekoski. (2011, December 23). What's the definition of a great book? <i>The Guardian</i> . Reproduced courtesy of Guardian News & Media Ltd. Used under GNM Open Licence 1.1 Retrieved from https://www.theguardian.com/books/2011/dec/23/definition-great-book-rick-gekoski
Section III Question 9	Zadie Smith. (2000). <i>White Teeth</i> . Penguin, London. (p. 9) Reproduced with permission Rogers, Coleridge & White Ltd., London

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2020

TRIAL HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE
EXAMINATION

English Advanced

Paper 1 – Texts and Human Experiences

Morning Session
Monday, 17 August 2020

General Instructions

- Reading time – 10 minutes
- Working time – 1 hour 30 minutes
- Write using black pen
- A Stimulus Booklet is provided with this paper.

Total marks – 40

Section I

Pages 2-7

20 marks

- Attempt Questions 1-4
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section II

Page 8

20 marks

- Attempt Question 5
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

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5000-1

20 marks

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
- analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts

Question 1 (4 marks)

“We were each in a series of our own moments that we stitched together to create our own story”.

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Question 2 (5 marks)

Use **Text 2** to answer this question.

How does the text reveal the importance of reflection in understanding human qualities and behaviours?

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Question 3 (5 marks)

Use **Text 3** to answer this question.

“The mask is not the incidental or even shameful apparatus of disability, but something this woman shapes and is shaped by: an integral feature of her being. Which, of course, it is.”

Analyse how Hildyard explores the idea of the relationship between humans and technology.

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Question 4 (6 marks)

Use **Text 4** and **ONE** other text (**Text 1, 2 or 3**) to answer this question.

Evaluate how Text 4 and ONE other text (Text 1, 2 or 3) represent the paradoxical nature of apparently simple experiences. Support your answer with evidence from both texts.

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Question 4 continues on page 7

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End of Section I

Section II

20 marks

Attempt Question 5

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question in a separate writing booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

In your answer you will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
 - analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts
 - organise, develop and express ideas using language appropriate to audience, purpose and context
-

Question 5 (20 marks)

We can never truly understand the motivations of others.

To what extent does this statement reflect your understanding of the human experience?

In your response, make detailed reference to your prescribed text.

The prescribed texts are listed on pages 6-7 of the Stimulus Booklet.

End of paper

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